

such as *Halo*, it gave much better results.

The Click Plus cordless is a great product, with its cool looks and impressive features. But considering the mixed

Price: Rs 4,300
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results in the gaming tests, usability may be restricted to mainstream office applications, and applications such as image editing software.

Logitech Cordless Click Plus		B	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶		
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶		
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶		
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶		

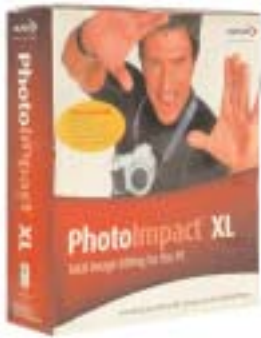
Ulead Photoimpact XL

XLent Impact

Ulead Photoimpact XL offers a little bit of everything—from full-fledged image editing to designing Web-page effects, to improving photos taken by digital cameras. The software has a very handy and one-step tool, called Express-Fix, which can analyse photographs and automatically display the correct options for retouching and restoring them, all within a few seconds. Images can be imported from a wide range of media, such as digital cameras, scanners, or straight off the Net.

Special effects and filters can be simply dragged and dropped on to a palette manager, which also allows for a quick preview of the selected filter. Photoimpact also boasts of some very useful, creative effects such as lightning and meteor showers, which can be animated effortlessly.

With all its features, Photoimpact XL does have some serious limitations. The main disadvantage is its inability



to work with the CMYK image format. On opening a CMYK file, the software immediately converts the image into 48-bit RGB, which is very inconvenient for professionals involved with heavy-duty editing. Also, the interface could do with some tweaking. Ultimately, although Photoimpact XL can do with a little improvement, its huge repertoire of tools, along with its uncomplicated and savvy design, make it stand out from the crowd of mid-level image editors. Considering the high price of the recently released Adobe Photoshop Creative Suite, Photoimpact XL, with its comparatively low price is a good purchase choice.

SPECIFICATIONS

Microsoft Windows XP, 98SE, NT 4.0 SP6, 2000, ME, Intel Pentium II or better, 64 MB RAM (256 MB recommended), 450 MB hard drive space

MSI 865PE Neo2		B+	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶		
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶		
Ease of use	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶		
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶		

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